



STARTUP TACTICS · TACTICAL PLAYBOOK

MARKET RESEARCH

Team NBC (Next Billion Children), built by Algo Peers

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Fall 2026 · Week of 28 September 2026 · Primary and secondary market research playbook

LEARNING INFRASTRUCTURE FOR THE NEXT BILLION CHILDREN

Elevator pitch: AI makes answers cheap, but the chance for children to investigate, build, get it wrong and try again is still costly. NBC builds **programmable physical learning environments where children build, experiment and develop capabilities with shared AI**, starting from five years of Algo Peers practice in Cape Coast, Ghana.

First customer

Independent operators of recurring hands-on programmes for children aged about 9–12, starting in Cape Coast.

Offer

NBC Learning Worlds: reusable physical experiences, facilitator guidance and a short evidence summary.

Stage

Pre-traction. Algo Peers has 1,000+ children reached and paying families; NBC pilots start this term.

WHAT WE WANT TO LEARN THIS WEEK

Part 1 · What we want

Find **one recurring learning problem** painful enough for a programme operator to change a programme or pay for support, and identify **who decides and pays**.

Part 2 · Hypotheses

H1 Operators can't easily tell whether a child can use an idea in a new task.

H2 Hands-on sessions stop when the one skilled facilitator is absent.

H3 Operators would pay for reusable experiences and support that cut preparation.

H4 Parents value seeing how their child tackles a challenge, not scores.

Part 3 · Experiment

Find 10+ watering holes; send 10 first messages, then 10 revised ones; run **12–16 problem interviews** across operators, facilitators, parents and researchers; code them in an insights grid. **No product pitch** until the problem is explored.

Balance rules: at least half of operator interviews not connected to Algo Peers; constrained and tech-rich settings both represented; adults only, with verbal consent.

PROBLEM INTERVIEW SCRIPT (PMR V1)

1. Walk me through the last practical learning session you ran.
2. Tell me about the last time a child finished an activity but you weren't sure what they understood.
3. What did you do next? What did that take?
4. Show me how you record progress or explain it to a family.
5. Describe a time a learner used an idea successfully in a different activity.
6. What makes practical sessions hard to repeat with another facilitator?
7. What have you paid for to improve this programme? How was that decided?
8. Which tools or routines work well enough that you'd keep them?
9. (After the problem) Here is a scoped pilot. What would have to happen for it to fit?
10. What is the actual process for approving money, delivery and a start date?

Rules

Open with consent: voluntary, adults only, notes taken.
Capture real examples before mentioning NBC. Record refusals and reasons. **A compliment is not a buying signal.**

Fields logged

Role · setting · warm or new · recent problem · workaround · consequence · frequency · buyer · budget process · existing spend · offer response · next concrete step.

WHERE OUR PMR SUBJECTS GATHER

G1 · TEACHER AND MENTOR NETWORK

Ghana Code Club
7,000 teachers · 22 centres
Programme reach, self-reported
Ghanaian teachers running children's coding clubs: our users and operators.
ghanacodeclub.org

G2 · ORGANISATION AND CLUB COACHES

Ghana Robotics Academy Foundation
Robofest clubs
Member count not public
Club owners and coaches decide what to run and pay for: our buyers.
foundation.ghanarobotics.org

G3 · LIBRARIAN TRAINERS

Ghana Library Authority
15 libraries
Head librarians and ICT coordinators
Library-hosted recurring sessions with few devices: an institutional host.
library.gov.gh

G4 · TEACHER ASSOCIATION

Ghana Society for Education and Technology
~20,000 members
Self-reported, by 2022
Tech-interested Ghanaian teachers: users and early adopters.
gset.education

G5 · STEAM OPERATOR

The MakersPlace (Accra)
10,000+ learners
Self-reported since 2019; 100+ teachers trained
A peer operator with parents and facilitators: buyer and user.
makersplacegh.com

Plus in person: Cape Coast after-school and club operators have no online community, so we canvass them directly.

Desk research, 25 Sep 2026. Sizes come from each community's or organiser's own pages; live counts and screenshots are captured when opened while logged in.

CONTRAST, PRACTITIONER AND RESEARCH COMMUNITIES

F1 · FACEBOOK GROUP

MakerSpaces and the Participatory Library

1,257 members

Indexed group page, undated

Library maker staff in tech-rich settings: our contrast site.

facebook.com/groups/librarymaker

M1 · PRACTITIONER NETWORK

micro:bit Champions

382 educators · 51 countries

Foundation's own figure

Educators running physical computing worldwide, including Ghana.

microbit.org/champions

M2 · MEETUP NETWORK

Scratch Educator Meetups

4,000+ members · 44 groups

Historical network figure

Educators using Scratch who run hands-on sessions.

scratchfoundation.org

T3 · REDDIT COMMUNITY

r/homeschool

~238,000 subscribers

Cached third-party figure

Parents of 9-12s: the family-offer test and a contrast.

reddit.com/r/homeschool

R1 · RESEARCH SOCIETY

International Society of the Learning Sciences

Global

Member count not public

Researchers who can set our sample and transfer measures.

isls.org

Desk research, 25 Sep 2026. Sizes come from each community's or organiser's own pages; live counts and screenshots are captured when opened while logged in.

FIRST OUTREACH MESSAGES

P1 · GRAF / club operator

DRAFT · NOT SENT

Email · 73 words

Dear [Name], congratulations to the Ghana Robotics Academy Foundation and Mikrobot Academy on the 2026 Robofest Junior title. I'm Sam Quansah, founder of Algo Peers in Cape Coast. I'm speaking with people who run recurring robotics or STEM clubs about how you tell whether a child can use what they learned when a new challenge looks different. Could you introduce me to two or three club coaches or owners for a 20-minute conversation?

P2 · Ghana Code Club

DRAFT · NOT SENT

Org-to-org email · 65 words

Dear Ghana Code Club team, I'm Sam Quansah, founder of Algo Peers in Cape Coast. I saw your launch of the “Coding & AI Without Computers” kits. Our programmes overlap, so to be open: this is research, not a sales pitch. I'm learning how facilitators keep hands-on sessions going when a trained facilitator moves on. Would someone who supports your facilitators talk for 20 minutes?

P3 · Ghana Library Authority

DRAFT · NOT SENT

Formal letter · 61 words

Dear [Programme Office], I'm Sam Quansah, founder of Algo Peers in Cape Coast. I read about the Authority's children's coding bootcamp and librarian training. With your permission, I'd like a 20-minute conversation with a librarian who has run these sessions, about what helps them continue with limited devices and what children can still do weeks later. I'd share a short summary.

P4 · Participatory Library group

DRAFT · NOT SENT

Group post (after admin OK) · 63 words

Hello everyone. With the admins' permission: I'm Sam Quansah, founder of Algo Peers and a Harvard GSE student (my own research, not a Harvard project). Can you recall a recent maker session where a child finished a project, perhaps with a tutorial or AI helping, and you weren't sure what they could do on their own next time? A 15–20-minute call would help.

P5 · Learning-sciences researcher

DRAFT · NOT SENT

Individual email · 58 words

Dear Dr [Name], I'm Sam Quansah, founder of Algo Peers and a Harvard GSE student, writing independently. I read your work on [topic]. We're planning a small feasibility study of whether children aged 9–12 can use the change-one-thing idea in an unfamiliar task. Before we fix the sample and measures, could I ask you 20 minutes of questions?

R1 · Facilitator community

DRAFT · NOT SENT

Community post · 61 words

Hello. I'm Sam Quansah from Algo Peers, which runs hands-on learning for children in Ghana. With the moderators' permission, I'm asking facilitators who run sessions for 9–12-year-olds about a recent session: what happened, what got in the way, and how you judged what each child could do afterwards. A 15-minute call or a voice note would help. There's nothing to buy.

FIRST OUTREACH MESSAGES

R2 · Programme owner

DRAFT · NOT SENT

LinkedIn message · 57 words

Dear [Name], I'm Sam Quansah, founder of Algo Peers in Cape Coast. I see you lead [Programme]. I'm talking with people who run recurring hands-on learning for children about how they decide what to keep, change or pay for, and what evidence they use. Would you share your experience in a 20-minute call? I'm asking, not selling.

R3 · Makerspace practitioner

DRAFT · NOT SENT

Forum / DM · 60 words

Hi [Name], I'm Sam Quansah from Algo Peers in Ghana, where we run children's physical-computing sessions. I'm researching how practitioners notice whether a child has understood an idea, like testing one change at a time, rather than just finishing the build. Could you describe the last time you weren't sure? A reply, voice note or 15-minute call would be welcome.

R4 · Parent community

DRAFT · NOT SENT

Group post (after mod OK) · 56 words

Hello. I'm Sam Quansah, founder of Algo Peers. With the moderators' permission, I'd like to hear from parents of 9–12-year-olds about a recent time your child made or investigated something, and how you could tell what they understood, especially if an app or AI helped. I'm not contacting children. A 15-minute conversation with you would help.

R5 · Assessment researcher

DRAFT · NOT SENT

Individual email · 62 words

Dear Dr [Name], I'm Sam Quansah, founder of Algo Peers and a Harvard GSE student, writing independently. Your work on [topic] fits a question we're working on: how to tell, validly and cheaply, whether a child can use an idea in a task that looks different weeks later. Could I ask you a few questions in 20 minutes? I'd welcome your critique.

Drafted 25 Sep 2026 from the watering-hole research. Each refers to something verifiable, asks about one recent experience, and makes one small request. [Brackets] are personalised per recipient. Screenshots of each sent message are added as they go out.

REFINED OUTREACH MESSAGES

P1 · GRAF / club operator

DRAFT · NOT SENT

Email · 59 words

Dear [Name], congratulations on the 2026 Robofest Junior title. Can you describe the last time a club member built something well but struggled when the challenge changed? I'm Sam Quansah, founder of Algo Peers in Cape Coast, researching exactly that. There's nothing to sell. Could you point me to two coaches for a 15-minute call or a voice note?

P2 · Ghana Code Club

DRAFT · NOT SENT

Org-to-org email · 50 words

Dear Ghana Code Club team, a research question, not a pitch: when a trained facilitator moves on, what keeps a centre's hands-on sessions going? I'm Sam Quansah (Algo Peers, Cape Coast). A 15-minute call or a short voice note from someone who supports your facilitators would help us a lot.

P3 · Ghana Library Authority

DRAFT · NOT SENT

Formal letter · 50 words

Dear [Programme Office], with your permission I'd like to learn from one librarian who ran the children's coding sessions: what helped the sessions continue with few devices, and what children could still do weeks later? 15 minutes, voluntary, with a summary shared back. Sam Quansah, founder, Algo Peers (Cape Coast).

P4 · Participatory Library group

DRAFT · NOT SENT

Group post (after admin OK) · 61 words

With the admins' OK: can you describe the last time a child finished a maker project, maybe with a tutorial or AI helping, and you weren't sure they could do it alone next time? I'm collecting stories (no product, nothing to buy) for independent research. Comment or message me; a 10-minute chat or voice note is plenty. Sam Quansah, Algo Peers

P5 · Learning-sciences researcher

DRAFT · NOT SENT

Individual email · 57 words

Dear Dr [Name], one question from your work on [topic]: how would you measure, cheaply and validly, whether a 9–12-year-old can use the change-one-thing idea in an unfamiliar task weeks later? I'm designing a small feasibility study in Ghana and a contrasting site. 15 minutes of your critique would shape it. Sam Quansah (Algo Peers; writing independently)

R1 · Facilitator community

DRAFT · NOT SENT

Community post · 45 words

Facilitators of 9–12-year-olds: can you describe your last hands-on session where a child finished but you weren't sure what they'd learned? There's nothing to buy. I'm Sam Quansah (Algo Peers, Ghana), collecting real examples. A voice note or 10-minute call helps. Posted with moderator permission.

REFINED OUTREACH MESSAGES

R2 · Programme owner

DRAFT · NOT SENT

LinkedIn message · 48 words

Dear [Name], quick question as someone who runs [Programme]: what was the last thing you paid for to improve your hands-on sessions, and how did you decide? I'm researching this, not selling anything. Would you share it in a 15-minute call? Sam Quansah, founder, Algo Peers (Cape Coast)

R3 · Makerspace practitioner

DRAFT · NOT SENT

Forum / DM · 44 words

Hi [Name], can you describe the last time a child finished a build but you doubted they understood why it worked? I'm Sam Quansah (Algo Peers, Ghana), researching how practitioners spot real understanding. A two-line reply or voice note is plenty. Nothing to sell.

R4 · Parent community

DRAFT · NOT SENT

Group post (after mod OK) · 49 words

Parents of 9–12-year-olds: when your child last built or tested something, how could you tell what they really understood, especially if an app or AI helped? I'm Sam Quansah (Algo Peers), researching this. I'm not contacting children and there's nothing to buy. A 10-minute chat with you would help.

R6 · Follow-up (once, day 5–7)

DRAFT · NOT SENT

Same channel · 43 words

Hello [Name], following up once on my note about [recent sessions]. If now isn't a good time, no problem and no need to reply. If you'd like to help, a short voice note or 10 minutes would be very welcome. Thank you, Sam

Revised with our rules for real responses: open with "Can you describe the last time...", say "nothing to buy" early, offer a voice note, cut length by about a third. Re-revise once real replies come in. [Brackets] are personalised per recipient. Screenshots of each sent message are added as they go out.

HOW WE LOG EVERY CONVERSATION

COMMUNITY	PERMISSION	SENT (N)	REPLIES (N/SENT)	QUALIFIED INTERVIEWS		ROLE	SETTING	CONNECTED?	MESSAGE VERSION	ONE-LINE FINDING
G2 GRAF / clubs	-	0	-	-	0	Buyer	Constrained	-	P1 v1	-
G1 Ghana Code Club	-	0	-	-	0	User	Constrained	-	P2 v1	-
G3 Library Authority	-	0	-	-	0	Host	Constrained	-	P3 v1	-
Cape Coast canvassing	n/a	0	-	-	0	Buyer	Constrained	-	R1/R2	-
F1 Participatory Library	-	0	-	-	0	User	Tech-rich	-	P4 v1	-
R1 ISLS researchers	n/a	0	-	-	0	Research	Both	-	P5 v1	-

Status, 28 Sep 2026: 0 of 10 interviews done. Outreach starts this week. Each interview is logged the same day with the fields from our script; notes screenshots from this tracker are added weekly.

WHAT WE KNOW SO FAR, AND WHAT WE DON'T

DESK RESEARCH · SOURCED

Channel findings

Cape Coast operators have no online community, so in-person canvassing is essential. Ghana networks are organisation-led (Code Club, GRAF, libraries), so introductions beat posts. micro:bit Champions applications are closed until December.

SIMULATED REHEARSAL · NOT EVIDENCE

Hypotheses to test

A rehearsal of our script with 10 simulated personas suggested: sessions stop when "the one person" is absent; buyers want peer proof and written terms more than a lower price; parents at schools judge on exam marks. **We treat these only as questions.**

REAL PMR · PENDING

Findings from real interviews

None yet. The consolidated findings document fills in as interviews happen, reported by segment with counts and denominators.

TEN PLANNED INTERVIEWS, FIVE PROBLEMS TO RATE

PARTICIPANT	SOURCE	ROLE	SETTING	P1 CAN'T TELL IF SKILL TRANSFERS	P2 STOPS WITHOUT KEY FACILITATOR	P3 PREP TIME TOO HIGH	P4 HARD TO SHOW FAMILIES PROGRESS	P5 NO BUDGET ROUTE
Operator 1	GRAF club owner	Buyer	Constrained	.	.	.	.	.
Operator 2	Cape Coast after-school owner	Buyer	Constrained	.	.	.	.	.
Operator 3	Cape Coast after-school owner	Buyer	Constrained	.	.	.	.	.
Facilitator 1	Ghana Code Club centre	User	Constrained	.	.	.	.	.
Facilitator 2	Ghana Code Club centre	User	Constrained	.	.	.	.	.
Librarian	Ghana Library Authority	Host	Constrained	.	.	.	.	.
Library maker lead	Participatory Library	User	Tech-rich	.	.	.	.	.
Parent 1	Algo Peers family (connected)	Buyer	Constrained	.	.	.	.	.
Parent 2	r/homeschool	Buyer	Tech-rich	.	.	.	.	.
Researcher	ISLS	Research	Both	.	.	.	.	.

Each cell is rated 0–3 after the interview (0 not raised, 3 raised unprompted with a recent example). We report how many of 10 rate each problem 2 or more, by segment, and never average across segments.

HOW THIS TACTIC MOVES NBC

How it relates to our business

It decides our first customer and problem. The v5 plan depends on one recurring problem and one buyer, confirmed by people outside our network.

Steps we took

- 1 · Defined segments and qualification rules.
- 2 · Mapped 20 watering holes from sources; picked 10.
- 3 · Wrote the PMR script.
- 4 · Drafted 10 messages, then 10 revisions.
- 5 · Built the tracker and insights grid.
- 6 · Rehearsed the script with simulated personas.

Link to earlier tactics

Builds on our segmentation, personas and the 24-step business plan. Synthetic studies shaped the questions; real PMR now tests them.

Leverage it in future

The same watering holes recruit pilot sites, outside facilitators and a contrasting research site.

How it advances NBC

It feeds our first pass line: offers to 10 qualified buyers, and 3 paid commitments, by week 6.

LEARNING WORLDS ARE DESIGNED EXPERIENCES

1 · Belong

A story and a real problem from the child's world.

2 · Investigate

Build with micro:bit, sensors and everyday materials; ask AI good questions.

3 · Understand

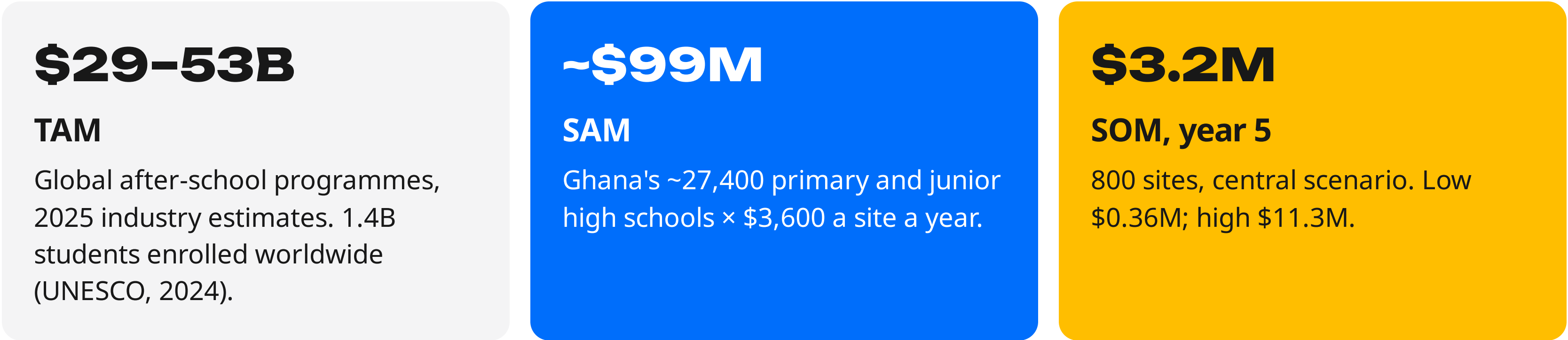
Predict, test, explain, revise.

4 · Apply

Build for someone real; show the skill in a new situation.

Example already run by Algo Peers, Farm World: 51 learners aged 7–15 from 34 communities (53% girls) built 7 working prototypes for food security. Participation and outputs, not a measured learning effect.

MARKET SIZE AND FIVE-YEAR SCENARIOS



Projections from stated assumptions, not forecasts; rebuilt from pilot data. Details: docs in the nbc-vct repository.

A BRAND GUIDE, AND THE TEAM IN PUBLIC



Sam Quansah
Founder



Vera Aninakwah
Learning Designer



Nana Adwoa Nsiah
Learning Experience
Designer



Deborah Quansah
Sales and Marketing Lead

Brand

NBC brand guide (14 pages) on the Algo Peers system: colour carries the thesis (experience, intelligence, evidence, capability, action). Master line: "Learning infrastructure for the next billion children."

EIGHT WEEKS TO A CLEAR DECISION

WEEK	DATES	WORK	DEADLINE / DECISION
1	28 Sep – 4 Oct	Send P1–P5; canvass Cape Coast; first 6 conversations	Which learning problem and buyer to serve
2	5 – 11 Oct	12–16 conversations; task review; costed pilot offer; v2 messages	One offer and one bounded learning claim
3	12 – 18 Oct	Task usability sessions; baseline; offers to 10 qualified buyers	Fix tasks; choose the least capture that works
4	19 – 25 Oct	Outside facilitators deliver; log prep, help and explanations	Kit, supported programme or redesign
5	26 Oct – 1 Nov	Delayed, unfamiliar task, scored blind	Is richer capture worth it?
6	2 – 8 Nov	Repeat delivery; payments, decisions and costs	Pass line: 3 of 10 buyers pay
7	9 – 15 Nov	Contrasting site, if access is ready	What travels, what needs adapting
8	16 – 20 Nov	Review every gate	Closeout 20 Nov: repeat, simplify, change payer or pause

Weekly: submit the tactic deck (PDF) and update the decision record. Plan from the NBC Tactical Playbook v5 (planning window 25 Sep – 20 Nov 2026).